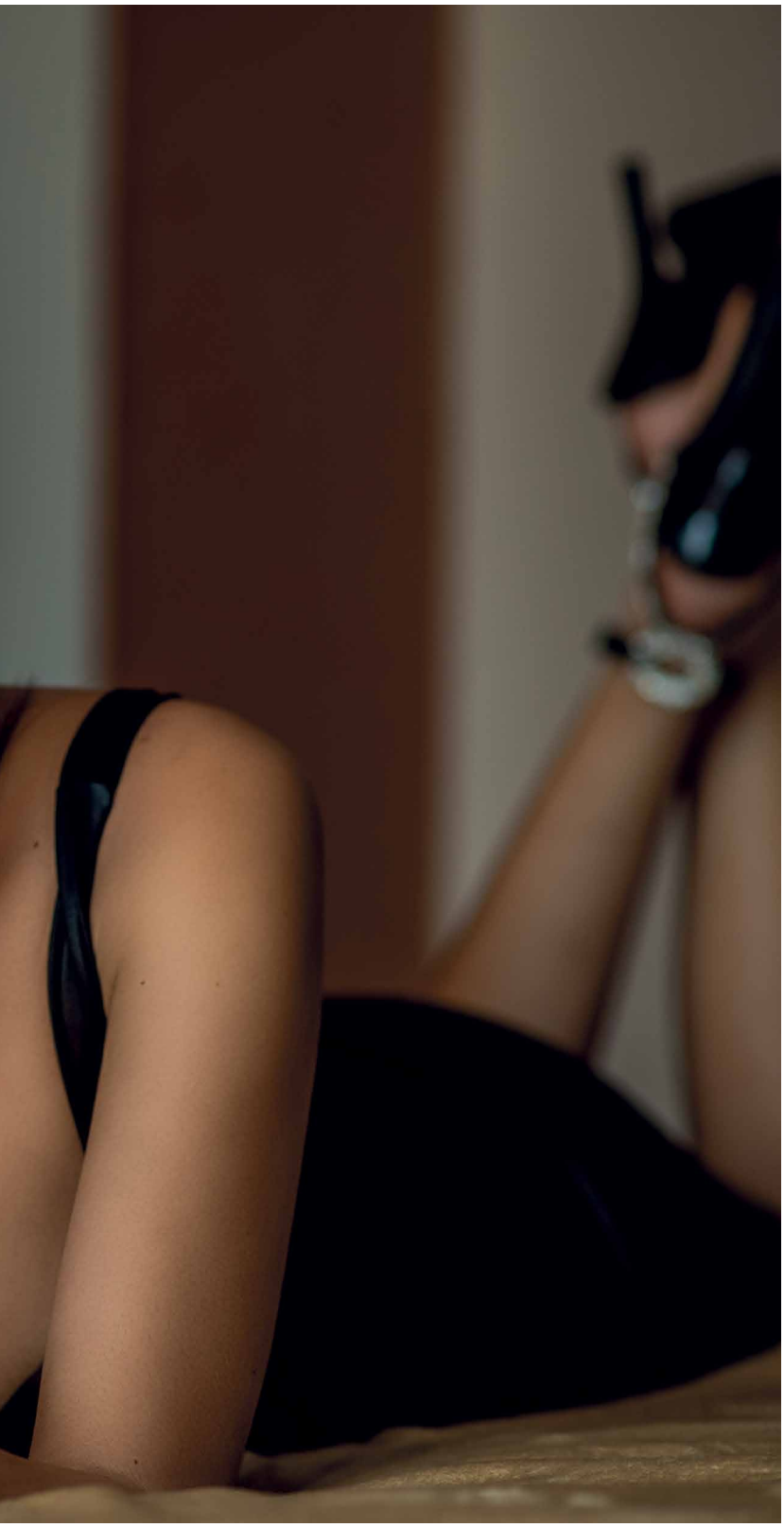


START

THERE IS A WIDE GENERATION GAP WHEN IT COMES TO SEXUAL ATTITUDES, WITH THE YOUNG MORE WILLING TO EXPERIMENT

By **SONALI ACHARJEE**

Photographs by **BANDEEP SINGH**

THE GENERATION GAP BETWEEN 14-year-old Neha Kapoor *(name changed)* and her 27-year-old sister Jyoti is never more apparent than when it comes to the topic of sex. The Delhi-based siblings say they were shocked to learn how differently they viewed physical intimacy. While Neha doesn't bat an eyelid if one of her friends at a popular south Delhi school hooks up with someone, Jyoti, a website designer, has the complete opposite reaction. "For me, sex still means something. It is not something you have freely and carelessly. But my sister is the opposite, sex is like breathing. They are more shocked if someone hasn't had sex than if someone has," says Jyoti.

The INDIA TODAY sex survey 2023, too, records this slow generational shift, with more people having sex in their teens today than before. In 2018, around 24 per cent had sex between 13 and 19. Today, the results show the figure to be 35 per cent. A similar attitude can be noted when it comes to the significance